



CHAPTER 01

UPSC CIVIL SERVICES SYLLABUS - DECODED

SYLLABURSUS



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SYLLABURSUS

GENERAL STUDIES PAPER-I

Indian Heritage and Culture, History and Geography of the World and Society

1. Indian Culture & Heritage

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Indian culture will cover the salient aspects of Art Forms, literature and Architecture from ancient to modern times."

DECODED TOPICS:

Major Indian art forms, literary traditions and architectural traditions from ancient to modern India.

MICROTOPICS:

- Major architectural traditions: Harappan, Buddhist, rock-cut, temple, Indo-Islamic and colonial
- Nagara, Dravida and Vesara traditions
- Major literary traditions, languages and movements
- Classical performing and visual arts
- Bhakti and Sufi cultural traditions
- Major painting traditions

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Structural features, stylistic distinctions, historical context, literary traditions, cultural significance and patronage.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid exhaustive memorisation of obscure local variants, isolated artists or insignificant sites without wider historical/cultural relevance.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Heritage conservation, UNESCO recognition, restoration, cultural institutions and antiquities repatriation where relevant to static topics.

2. Modern Indian History

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Modern Indian history from about the middle of the eighteenth century until the present- significant events, personalities, issues."

DECODED TOPICS:

Colonial expansion, transformation of Indian political and economic structures, colonial policies, resistance and major social developments.

MICROTOPICS:

- Expansion and consolidation of British rule
- Land revenue systems
- Economic impact of colonialism and drain theory
- Socio-religious reform movements
- Peasant and tribal resistance
- Major personalities, events and issues

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Policy changes, causes and consequences, economic impact, reform objectives and historical significance.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid tactical details of minor battles and routine colonial administrative records.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant anniversaries, heritage commemorations and contemporary debates connected to historical developments.

3. Freedom Struggle

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"The Freedom Struggle — its various stages and important contributors/contributions from different parts of the country."

DECODED TOPICS:

Evolution of nationalism, phases of the freedom movement, mass mobilisation, ideological streams and constitutional developments.

MICROTOPICS:

- Early nationalism and Moderate–Extremist phase
- Gandhian movements
- Revolutionary nationalism
- Peasant and worker movements
- States' Peoples' movements
- Contributions from different regions
- Constitutional developments leading to independence and Partition

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Causes, objectives, methods, ideological differences, major organisations, movements and constitutional developments.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid isolated local histories unless they illuminate a broader national/regional movement.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant commemorations, historical personalities and heritage/memorial developments.

4. Post-Independence Consolidation

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Post-independence consolidation and reorganization within the country."

DECODED TOPICS:

Political, territorial and social consolidation of independent India.

MICROTOPICS:

- Integration of princely states
- Linguistic reorganisation
- Tribal integration and constitutional safeguards
- Early nation-building and planned development
- Major post-independence consolidation challenges

PYQ SIGNAL: Moderate

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Conceptual

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Understand the logic, challenges and consequences of political, territorial and social integration.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid detailed electoral histories that do not illuminate consolidation or reorganisation.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant state/UT reorganisation, boundary or integration issues.

5. World History

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"History of the world will include events from 18th century such as industrial revolution, world wars, redrawal of national boundaries, colonization, decolonization, political philosophies like communism, capitalism, socialism etc. — their forms and effect on the society."

DECODED TOPICS:

Major global transformations from the 18th century onward and their social, political and economic consequences.

MICROTOPICS:

- Industrial Revolution
- Major political revolutions
- Capitalism, socialism and communism
- Imperialism and colonisation
- World Wars
- Redrawing of boundaries
- Decolonisation

PYQ SIGNAL: Moderate

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Conceptual

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Causes, processes, consequences, ideological transformation and broad geopolitical changes.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid detailed battle tactics, troop movements and minor diplomatic events.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Contemporary developments may be linked to relevant historical boundaries, colonial legacies or ideological transformations.

6. Indian Society & Diversity

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

“Salient features of Indian Society, Diversity of India.”

DECODED TOPICS:

Pluralism, social structure, diversity, continuity and change in Indian society.

MICROTOPICS:

- Diversity and pluralism
- Caste and social change
- Tribal communities and issues
- Family and kinship changes
- Social integration
- Rural–urban social transformation

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Structural features, continuity/change, constitutional safeguards and contemporary social challenges.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid extensive academic sociological theory not useful for understanding Indian society.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant demographic, social, tribal and community developments.

7. Social Issues

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Role of women and women's organization, population and associated issues, poverty and developmental issues, urbanization, their problems and their remedies."

DECODED TOPICS:

Gender, population, poverty, development and urbanisation as interconnected social issues.

MICROTOPICS:

- Women's participation and empowerment
- Women's organisations
- Demographic change, demographic dividend and ageing
- Poverty and inequality
- Urbanisation, slums and urban infrastructure
- Social and developmental consequences

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Causes, consequences, indicators, institutional responses and remedies.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid highly local administrative rules or isolated organisational details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant demographic releases, urbanisation trends, poverty indicators and gender-related developments.

8. Globalization & Social Ideologies

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Effects of globalization on Indian society. Social empowerment, communalism, regionalism & secularism."

DECODED TOPICS:

Social effects of globalisation and major forces shaping Indian social cohesion and identity.

MICROTOPICS:

- Globalisation and Indian society
- Social empowerment
- Regionalism
- Communalism
- Secularism
- Cultural and social change

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Concepts, causes, consequences and Indian social context.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid partisan commentary on isolated political disputes.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant social, judicial and cultural developments.

9. World Physical Geography

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Salient features of world's physical geography."

DECODED TOPICS:

Major physical processes and geographical systems shaping the Earth.

MICROTOPICS:

- Earth structure and plate tectonics
- Geomorphic processes and landforms
- Atmosphere and atmospheric circulation
- Climate systems and major phenomena
- Oceanography
- Ocean currents, temperature and salinity
- Coral systems

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Physical processes, mechanisms, spatial patterns and cause-effect relationships.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid advanced mathematical modelling and technical forecasting systems.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant earthquakes, volcanic activity, climate anomalies, monsoon behaviour and oceanographic developments.

10. Natural Resources Distribution & Industrial Location

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Distribution of key natural resources across the world (including South Asia and the Indian sub-continent); factors responsible for the location of primary, secondary, and tertiary sector industries in various parts of the world (including India)."

DECODED TOPICS:

Spatial distribution of resources and geographical factors influencing economic activity and industrial location.

MICROTOPICS:

- Major mineral and energy resources
- Water resources
- Resource distribution and spatial patterns
- Location factors for primary, secondary and tertiary activities
- Major industrial regions and corridors

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Distribution patterns, location factors and geographical reasoning.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid exhaustive inventories of minor local resources or individual industrial units.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Critical minerals, new resource developments, energy projects and industrial corridors.

11. Geophysical Phenomena & Critical Feature Changes

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Important Geophysical phenomena such as earthquakes, Tsunami, Volcanic activity, cyclone etc., geographical features and their location-changes in critical geographical features (including water-bodies and ice-caps) and in flora and fauna and the effects of such changes."

DECODED TOPICS:

Major geophysical hazards and changes in geographical and ecological features.

MICROTOPICS:

- Earthquakes
- Tsunamis
- Volcanic activity
- Cyclones
- Landslides and related hazards
- Changes in glaciers, ice caps and water bodies
- Sea-level change
- Changes affecting flora and fauna

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Causes, mechanisms, spatial patterns, impacts and geographical consequences.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid highly technical forecasting algorithms and operational rescue engineering.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major hazard events and significant geographical/ecological changes.

GENERAL STUDIES PAPER-II

Governance, Constitution, Polity, Social Justice and International Relations

1. Constitutional Framework & Basic Structure

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

“Indian Constitution—historical underpinnings, evolution, features, amendments, significant provisions and basic structure.”

DECODED TOPICS:

Constitutional evolution, structure, significant provisions, amendments and basic structure.

MICROTOPICS:

- Constitutional history
- Preamble
- Fundamental Rights
- DPSP
- Fundamental Duties
- Amendment procedure
- Basic Structure Doctrine
- Major constitutional doctrines

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Constitutional provisions, doctrines and significant Supreme Court judgments.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid irrelevant or minor judicial observations without constitutional significance.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Significant constitutional judgments, constitutional amendments and major constitutional debates.

2. Federal Structure & Local Devolution

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Functions and responsibilities of the Union and the States, issues and challenges pertaining to the federal structure, devolution of powers and finances up to local levels and challenges therein."

DECODED TOPICS:

Union-State relations, federal challenges, fiscal federalism and decentralisation.

MICROTOPICS:

- Legislative, administrative and financial relations
- Legislative Lists
- Finance Commission
- Governor and federal tensions
- Emergency provisions
- Special constitutional provisions
- Panchayats and Municipalities
- Devolution of functions, funds and functionaries

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Constitutional structure, major conflicts, fiscal relations and decentralisation.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid isolated local disputes without wider constitutional relevance.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Governor-related developments, Finance Commission issues, inter-State disputes and local-government reforms.

3. Separation of Powers & Dispute Redressal

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Separation of powers between various organs dispute redressal mechanisms and institutions."

DECODED TOPICS:

Checks and balances, separation of powers and mechanisms for resolving disputes.

MICROTOPICS:

- Executive–Legislature–Judiciary relations
- Judicial review
- Tribunals
- Alternative Dispute Resolution
- Lok Adalats and arbitration

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Institutional relationships, checks and balances and major dispute-resolution mechanisms.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid detailed procedural law outside the syllabus context.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Significant tribunal, judicial independence and dispute-resolution developments.

4. Comparison of Constitutional Schemes

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Comparison of the Indian constitutional scheme with that of other countries."

DECODED TOPICS:

Comparative constitutional structures and principles relevant to India.

MICROTOPICS:

- Parliamentary and presidential systems
- Constitutional supremacy and parliamentary sovereignty
- Executive-legislative relationships
- Judicial structures
- Comparative constitutional principles

PYQ SIGNAL: Moderate

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Conceptual

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Structural comparisons and their implications.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid detailed foreign jurisprudence unrelated to comparative analysis.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant constitutional reforms or institutional developments abroad.

5. Parliament & State Legislatures

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Parliament and State legislatures—structure, functioning, conduct of business, powers & privileges and issues arising out of these."

DECODED TOPICS:

Legislative institutions, procedures, powers, privileges and functioning.

MICROTOPICS:

- Structure and functioning
- Legislative procedure
- Types of Bills
- Money Bills
- Parliamentary committees
- Privileges
- Delegated legislation
- Ordinance-making power

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Legislative scrutiny, accountability, committees, privileges and legislative procedures.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid day-to-day procedural controversies without broader significance.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Significant legislative, parliamentary privilege, anti-defection and electoral-reform developments.

6. Executive, Judiciary & Pressure Groups

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Structure, organization and functioning of the Executive and the Judiciary—Ministries and Departments of the Government; pressure groups and formal/informal associations and their role in the Polity."

DECODED TOPICS:

Executive and judicial functioning and the role of organised interests in policymaking.

MICROTOPICS:

- Executive structure
- Cabinet system
- Judiciary and judicial independence
- Judicial appointments
- PIL
- Pressure groups
- Formal and informal associations

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Structure, accountability, independence and influence on policymaking.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid minor departmental organisational charts.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Significant judicial, executive and pressure-group developments.

7. Representation of People Acts

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

“Salient features of the Representation of People’s Act.”

DECODED TOPICS:

Statutory framework governing elections and electoral representation.

MICROTOPICS:

- Representation of the People Act, 1950
- Representation of the People Act, 1951
- Electoral qualifications and disqualifications
- Electoral offences and corrupt practices
- Election-related statutory provisions
- Political party and electoral regulation where supported by the Acts

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Understand major statutory provisions affecting elections, candidates and electoral integrity.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid booth-level operational details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major electoral-law amendments, Election Commission developments and significant electoral judgments.

IMPORTANT PURIFICATION:

Anti-Defection Law is not a provision of the Representation of the People Acts. It belongs to the Constitution, Tenth Schedule. It should therefore be studied under the constitutional/electoral framework, not represented as an RPA provision.

8. Constitutional, Statutory & Regulatory Bodies

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Appointment to various Constitutional posts, powers, functions and responsibilities of various Constitutional Bodies. Statutory, regulatory and various quasi-judicial bodies."

DECODED TOPICS:

Appointment, powers, functions, independence, accountability and functioning of important public institutions.

MICROTOPICS:

- Constitutional bodies
- Statutory bodies
- Regulatory bodies
- Quasi-judicial bodies
- Appointment mechanisms
- Powers, functions and institutional autonomy

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Constitutional/statutory basis, composition, powers, functions, independence and major issues.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid routine internal administrative procedures of minor institutions.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major appointments, institutional reforms, important reports and significant legal developments.

9. Government Policies & Sectoral Interventions

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Government policies and interventions for development in various sectors and issues arising out of their design and implementation."

DECODED TOPICS:

Policy formulation, implementation, institutional coordination and development outcomes.

MICROTOPICS:

- Policy design
- Implementation gaps
- Centre-State and multi-level implementation
- Stakeholder participation
- Service delivery
- Evaluation of policy outcomes

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Understand why policies succeed or fail and how implementation can improve.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid memorising temporary scheme details without analytical relevance.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major government policies, schemes and significant implementation evaluations.

10. Development Processes, NGOs & SHGs

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

“Development processes and the development industry —the role of NGOs, SHGs, various groups and associations, donors, charities, institutional and other stakeholders.”

DECODED TOPICS:

Participatory development and the role of civil society and non-state stakeholders.

MICROTOPICS:

- NGOs and civil society
- SHGs
- Donors and charities
- Stakeholder participation
- Microfinance
- Regulation of development-sector organisations

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Roles, strengths, limitations, accountability and development impact.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid operational details of individual organisations.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant NGO regulation, SHG developments and civil-society initiatives.

11. Welfare Schemes & Vulnerable Groups

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

“Welfare schemes for vulnerable sections of the population by the Centre and States and the performance of these schemes; mechanisms, laws, institutions and Bodies constituted for the protection and betterment of these vulnerable sections.”

DECODED TOPICS:

Welfare architecture, vulnerable groups, legal protection and implementation performance.

MICROTOPICS:

- Vulnerable groups
- Welfare schemes and delivery
- Legal protections
- Institutional safeguards
- Implementation gaps
- Social protection

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Targeting, delivery, outcomes, legal protections and institutional mechanisms.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid memorising temporary administrative details of individual schemes.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major welfare reforms, scheme evaluations, legal developments and vulnerable-group issues.

12. Social Sector — Health, Education & Human Resources

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

“Issues relating to development and management of Social Sector/Services relating to Health, Education, Human Resources.”

DECODED TOPICS:

Development and management of health, education and human-resource systems.

MICROTOPICS:

- Public health and healthcare delivery
- Education access, quality and reform
- Human capital
- Skills and employability
- Major institutional challenges

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Access, quality, equity, governance, outcomes and reforms.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid specialist clinical or highly technical academic details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major health, education, skill and human-capital reforms.

13. Poverty & Hunger

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Issues relating to poverty and hunger."

DECODED TOPICS:

Dimensions, causes, consequences and policy responses to poverty and hunger.

MICROTOPICS:

- Poverty measurement
- Multidimensional poverty
- Hunger and malnutrition
- Food security
- Poverty-human-capital linkages
- Policy interventions

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Concepts, measurement, causes, consequences and intervention effectiveness.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid obsolete methodological debates unless historically relevant.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Current poverty, nutrition and food-security indicators.

14. Governance, Transparency & E-Governance

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Important aspects of governance, transparency and accountability, e-governance- applications, models, successes, limitations, and potential; citizens charters, transparency & accountability and institutional and other measures."

DECODED TOPICS:

Mechanisms of accountable, transparent and technology-enabled governance.

MICROTOPICS:

- Transparency and accountability
- RTI
- E-governance applications and models
- Citizens' Charters
- Social audits
- Institutional accountability mechanisms

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Principles, applications, strengths, limitations and governance outcomes.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid software engineering or technical portal architecture.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Digital governance reforms, RTI developments and accountability initiatives.

15. Role of Civil Services in a Democracy

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Role of civil services in a democracy."

DECODED TOPICS:

Role, responsibilities, neutrality, accountability, responsiveness and reform of civil services.

MICROTOPICS:

- Political neutrality
- Accountability and responsiveness
- Generalist–specialist debate
- Administrative capacity
- Civil-service reform
- Public-service orientation

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Role, challenges, accountability and reform principles.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid detailed service-specific administrative rules.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major civil-service reform initiatives and significant administrative reforms.

16. India and Its Neighborhood

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"India and its neighborhood- relations."

DECODED TOPICS:

India's relations with neighbouring countries and the major security, economic and strategic dimensions of those relationships.

MICROTOPICS:

- Bilateral relations
- Border issues
- Connectivity
- Trade and economic relations
- Security concerns
- Regional cooperation

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Structural relationships, interests, challenges and opportunities.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid memorising routine diplomatic statements.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major bilateral developments, agreements, border developments and connectivity projects.

17. Bilateral, Regional & Global Groupings

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Bilateral, regional and global groupings and agreements involving India and/or affecting India's interests."

DECODED TOPICS:

International groupings, strategic partnerships and agreements relevant to India's interests.

MICROTOPICS:

- Major regional and global groupings
- Strategic partnerships
- Indo-Pacific frameworks
- Economic and trade agreements
- Connectivity initiatives
- India's interests and strategic positioning

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Membership, purpose, structure, strategic/economic significance and India's position.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid routine summit declarations unless they introduce a significant change.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major summits, agreements, membership changes and strategic developments.

18. Developed/Developing Countries, Policies & Indian Diaspora

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Effect of policies and politics of developed and developing countries on India's interests, Indian diaspora."

DECODED TOPICS:

External political and economic developments that affect India's interests and the Indian diaspora.

MICROTOPICS:

- Major geopolitical shifts
- Trade and protectionism
- Energy security
- Technology and strategic interests
- Diaspora
- Remittances and diaspora welfare

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Effects on India's strategic, economic, technological and diaspora interests.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid detailed domestic politics of foreign countries unless directly relevant to India.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major global conflicts, policy changes, sanctions, trade developments and diaspora issues.

19. Important International Institutions

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Important International institutions, agencies and fora- their structure, mandate."

DECODED TOPICS:

Major international institutions, their structure, functions, mandates and relevance to India.

MICROTOPICS:

- UN system
- International financial institutions
- WTO
- Major specialised agencies
- Important international fora
- Reform and representation issues

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Structure, mandate, functions, major issues and India's position.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid minor procedural details of subsidiary bodies.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major institutional reforms, negotiations, reports and international decisions.

GENERAL STUDIES PAPER–III

Technology, Economic Development, Bio-diversity, Environment, Security and Disaster Management

1. Indian Economy: Planning, Resource Mobilisation, Growth, Development & Employment

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Indian Economy and issues relating to planning, mobilization, of resources, growth, development and employment."

DECODED TOPICS:

The core economic architecture is:



Supporting concepts may be used to understand these areas.

MICROTOPICS:

- Economic planning and institutional evolution
- National income and major macroeconomic indicators
- Resource mobilisation
- Capital formation
- Growth vs development
- Employment and unemployment
- Structural transformation

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Macroeconomic concepts, resource mobilisation, growth, development and employment.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid advanced econometrics, corporate accounting and trading mechanics.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Economic Survey, Budget, RBI developments, major macroeconomic indicators and employment data.

PURIFICATION NOTE:

Banking, monetary policy, digital payments and related mechanisms may support this topic, but they must **not** replace the official economic architecture.

2. Inclusive Growth & Issues

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Inclusive growth and issues arising from it."

DECODED TOPICS:

Growth that improves participation, access, opportunity and outcomes across sections of society.

MICROTOPICS:

- Inequality
- Financial inclusion
- Access to opportunities
- Social-sector investment
- Regional and social disparities
- Sustainability and inclusion

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Indicators, causes, policy mechanisms and outcomes.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid unrelated corporate theory.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Financial inclusion, inequality and inclusive-development indicators.

3. Government Budgeting

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Government Budgeting."

DECODED TOPICS:

Structure, principles and economic implications of government budgeting.

MICROTOPICS:

- Receipts and expenditure
- Revenue and capital components
- Fiscal deficit
- Revenue deficit
- Primary deficit
- Fiscal policy
- FRBM framework
- GST and public finances

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Classifications, fiscal concepts, policy implications and major institutional mechanisms.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid memorising every departmental allocation.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Union Budget, Finance Bill, GST developments and fiscal policy changes.

4. Cropping Patterns, Irrigation & Agricultural Marketing

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Major crops-cropping patterns in various parts of the country, - different types of irrigation and irrigation systems storage, transport and marketing of agricultural produce and issues and related constraints; e-technology in the aid of farmers."

DECODED TOPICS:

Agricultural geography, irrigation, post-harvest systems, agricultural markets and technology.

MICROTOPICS:

- Major crops and cropping patterns
- Crop requirements
- Irrigation systems
- Water-use efficiency
- Storage and transport
- Agricultural marketing
- E-technology for farmers

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Spatial patterns, crop requirements, irrigation efficiency, market constraints and technology.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid advanced agricultural science outside the syllabus requirement.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major agricultural reforms, digital agriculture and irrigation developments.

5. Farm Subsidies, MSP & Food Security

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Issues related to direct and indirect farm subsidies and minimum support prices; Public Distribution System-objectives, functioning, limitations, revamping; issues of buffer stocks and food security; Technology missions; economics of animal-rearing."

DECODED TOPICS:

Farm support, agricultural pricing, food distribution, food security and livestock economics.

MICROTOPICS:

- Direct and indirect subsidies
- MSP
- Procurement
- PDS
- Buffer stocks
- Food security
- Technology missions
- Economics of animal rearing

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Economic rationale, distortions, policy choices, food-security implications and institutional mechanisms.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid veterinary science and highly local market details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

MSP decisions, food-security reforms, PDS developments and relevant WTO issues.

6. Food Processing & Related Industries

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Food processing and related industries in India- scope' and significance, location, upstream and downstream requirements, supply chain management."

DECODED TOPICS:

Structure, significance, location and supply-chain dimensions of food processing.

MICROTOPICS:

- Scope and significance
- Location factors
- Upstream and downstream linkages
- Cold chains
- Storage and logistics
- Supply-chain management

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Economic significance, bottlenecks, infrastructure and value-chain issues.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid technical food-chemistry processes.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major food-processing policies, infrastructure and supply-chain developments.

7. Land Reforms

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Land reforms in India."

DECODED TOPICS:

Post-independence transformation of land relations and continuing land-governance challenges.

MICROTOPICS:

- Abolition of intermediaries
- Land ceilings
- Tenancy reforms
- Consolidation
- Land records
- Digitisation of land records

PYQ SIGNAL: Moderate

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Objectives, major reforms, outcomes and continuing challenges.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid state-specific litigation details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Land-record modernisation and relevant land-governance reforms.

8. Liberalization & Industrial Policy

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Effects of liberalization on the economy, changes in industrial policy and their effects on industrial growth."

DECODED TOPICS:

Economic liberalisation and its effects on industrial structure and growth.

MICROTOPICS:

- 1991 reforms
- Industrial policy changes
- Manufacturing
- Services
- MSMEs
- SEZs
- Labour-market implications

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Structural changes, benefits, limitations and industrial-growth challenges.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid corporate-level restructuring details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Industrial policy, MSME reforms, manufacturing initiatives and major labour-policy developments.

9. Infrastructure & Investment Models

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Infrastructure: Energy, Ports, Roads, Airports, Railways etc. Investment models."

DECODED TOPICS:

Infrastructure sectors and mechanisms for financing and delivering infrastructure.

MICROTOPICS:

- Energy
- Ports
- Roads
- Airports
- Railways
- Logistics
- PPP and major investment models

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Infrastructure needs, financing, PPP structures, risk allocation and development impact.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid engineering design details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major infrastructure projects, logistics initiatives and investment reforms.

10. Science & Technology Developments & Everyday Applications

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Science and Technology- developments and their applications and effects in everyday life."

DECODED TOPICS:

Scientific developments and their practical applications and social effects.

MICROTOPICS:

- Everyday technological applications
- Health technologies
- Materials and emerging applications
- Social and economic effects of technology

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Basic principles, applications, significance and implications.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid university-level theoretical derivations and laboratory procedures.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Significant scientific and technological developments.

11. Achievements of Indians & Indigenization of Technology

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Achievements of Indians in science & technology; indigenization of technology and developing new technology."

DECODED TOPICS:

Indian contributions to science and technology and efforts toward technological self-reliance.

MICROTOPICS:

- Major Indian scientific contributions
- Indigenous technological development
- Strategic technologies
- Technology self-reliance

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Contribution, purpose, technological significance and applications.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid technical specifications or classified details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major indigenous technological achievements and scientific developments.

12. Frontier Technologies & IPR

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Awareness in the fields of IT, Space, Computers, robotics, nano-technology, bio-technology and issues relating to intellectual property rights."

DECODED TOPICS:

Major emerging technology domains and intellectual-property issues relevant to society, economy and governance.

MICROTOPICS:

- IT and computing
- Space technology
- Robotics
- Nanotechnology
- Biotechnology
- Artificial Intelligence
- Emerging technologies
- Intellectual Property Rights

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Basic mechanisms, applications, opportunities, risks and major IPR principles.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid programming, laboratory protocols and specialist engineering detail.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Specific missions, breakthroughs, regulations, applications and major IPR developments.

PURIFICATION NOTE:

Individual missions, named technologies and specific products are **examples/current-affairs inputs**, not permanent mandatory microtopics.

13. Conservation, Pollution, Degradation & EIA

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Conservation, environmental pollution and degradation, environmental impact assessment."

DECODED TOPICS:

Conservation, pollution, environmental degradation and environmental assessment.

MICROTOPICS:

- Biodiversity conservation
- Protected areas
- Pollution
- Waste and environmental degradation
- Climate-change implications
- Environmental Impact Assessment
- Environmental governance and legislation

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Concepts, causes, impacts, conservation mechanisms, major laws and EIA principles.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid exhaustive species lists and advanced pollutant chemistry.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Climate negotiations, environmental-law developments, major conservation issues and EIA changes.

PURIFICATION NOTE:

International treaties and specific laws are **supporting frameworks/examples under the official themes**, not substitutes for the official syllabus wording.

14. Disaster Management

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Disaster and disaster management."

DECODED TOPICS:

Disaster risk, vulnerability, preparedness, mitigation, response and recovery.

MICROTOPICS:

- Hazard and vulnerability
- Risk assessment
- Disaster-risk reduction
- Preparedness and mitigation
- Institutional framework
- Major disaster-management principles

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Risk reduction, institutional mechanisms, preparedness, mitigation and resilience.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid engineering specifications of emergency equipment.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major disasters, policy responses, risk-reduction initiatives and institutional developments.

15. Development & Extremism

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Linkages between development and spread of extremism."

DECODED TOPICS:

Relationship between development deficits, governance failures and extremist mobilisation.

MICROTOPICS:

- Development deficits
- Governance gaps
- Socio-economic grievances
- Left-Wing Extremism
- Insurgency and development linkages
- Security-development balance

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Causes, development linkages, governance responses and policy challenges.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid operational/tactical security details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major policy developments, peace processes and significant security developments.

16. External State & Non-State Actors

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Role of external state and non-state actors in creating challenges to internal security."

DECODED TOPICS:

External and non-state actors that create internal-security challenges.

MICROTOPICS:

- State-sponsored challenges
- Proxy actors
- Terrorism
- Radicalisation
- Transnational networks
- External support to internal threats

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Nature of threats, mechanisms, consequences and broad counter-strategies.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid unverified intelligence claims and operational details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Verified security developments and significant geopolitical-security developments.

PURIFICATION NOTE:

Specific examples such as individual corridors or projects should remain **contextual examples**, not permanent syllabus requirements.

17. Cyber Security, Media & Money Laundering

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Challenges to internal security through communication networks, role of media and social networking sites in internal security challenges, basics of cyber security; money-laundering and its prevention."

DECODED TOPICS:

Internal-security challenges arising from communication networks, cyber threats, media/social networks and money laundering.

MICROTOPICS:

- Communication-network threats
- Cyber-security basics
- Critical information infrastructure
- Social-media risks and disinformation
- Money laundering
- Prevention and legal/institutional mechanisms

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Concepts, threats, institutional/legal responses and governance implications.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid programming, hacking instructions and technical cyber operations.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major cyber incidents, significant regulatory developments and important money-laundering judgments.

18. Border Management & Organised Crime

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Security challenges and their management in border areas - linkages of organized crime with terrorism."

DECODED TOPICS:

Border-security challenges and connections between organised crime and terrorism.

MICROTOPICS:

- Border geography and challenges
- Cross-border crime
- Smuggling
- Trafficking
- Narco-terrorism
- Crime–terror nexus
- Border management

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Geographical, security, socio-economic and institutional dimensions.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid operational deployment details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Major border developments, organised-crime trends and significant policy responses.

19. Security Forces & Agencies

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Various Security forces and agencies and their mandate."

DECODED TOPICS:

Mandates, jurisdictions and institutional roles of important security forces and agencies.

MICROTOPICS:

- Major Central Armed Police Forces
- Important security agencies
- Investigative agencies
- Intelligence institutions
- Legal/institutional framework governing security agencies

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Integrated

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Mandate, jurisdiction, institutional role, coordination and legal safeguards.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid operational rosters, weapon specifications and tactical details.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Significant institutional reforms, jurisdictional changes and major security-policy developments.

GENERAL STUDIES PAPER-IV

Ethics, Integrity and Aptitude

1. Ethics & Human Interface

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Ethics and Human Interface: Essence, determinants and consequences of Ethics in - human actions; dimensions of ethics; ethics - in private and public relationships."

DECODED TOPICS:

Nature of ethics, ethical behaviour and ethical dimensions of human relationships and actions.

MICROTOPICS:

- Essence of ethics
- Determinants and consequences
- Ethical dimensions
- Private and public relationships
- Application of ethical reasoning

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Clear definitions, distinctions and application to human conduct.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid abstract philosophy that does not improve ethical reasoning.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant contemporary ethical dilemmas.

PURIFICATION NOTE:

Deontology, utilitarianism and virtue ethics may be used as **value-addition frameworks**, but they are not official UPSC headings.

2. Human Values & Value Inculcation

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Human Values - lessons from the lives and teachings of great leaders, reformers and administrators; role of family society and educational institutions in inculcating values."

DECODED TOPICS:

Sources and development of human values and lessons from important leaders, reformers and administrators.

MICROTOPICS:

- Family and value formation
- Society and educational institutions
- Lessons from leaders and reformers
- Application of values to public service

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Value lessons and their application.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid full biographies and exhaustive philosophical histories.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant examples of leadership, public service and value-based conduct.

3. Attitude, Social Influence & Persuasion

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Attitude: content, structure, function; its influence and relation with thought and behaviour; moral and political attitudes; social influence and persuasion."

DECODED TOPICS:

Nature of attitude, relationship with behaviour and mechanisms of social influence and persuasion.

MICROTOPICS:

- Content, structure and functions of attitude
- Attitude and behaviour
- Moral and political attitudes
- Social influence
- Persuasion
- Administrative application

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Concepts and practical application.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid clinical psychology and unrelated diagnostic theory.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant examples of behavioural change and public communication.

4. Foundational Values for Civil Service

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

“Aptitude and foundational values for Civil Service, integrity, impartiality and non-partisanship, objectivity, dedication to public service, empathy, tolerance and compassion towards the weaker-sections.”

DECODED TOPICS:

Core values required for ethical and effective public service.

MICROTOPICS:

- Integrity
- Impartiality
- Non-partisanship
- Objectivity
- Dedication to public service
- Empathy
- Tolerance
- Compassion

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Definitions, distinctions, conflicts between values and practical administrative application.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid abstract value theory disconnected from public service.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant administrative and public-service examples.

5. Emotional Intelligence

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Emotional intelligence-concepts, and their utilities and application in administration and governance."

DECODED TOPICS:

Understanding and applying emotional intelligence in administration and governance.

MICROTOPICS:

- Emotional intelligence concepts
- Self-awareness
- Self-regulation
- Empathy
- Social skills
- Motivation
- Administrative application

PYQ SIGNAL: High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Concepts and administrative application.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid clinical psychological measurement systems.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant examples involving leadership, conflict and public administration.

6. Moral Thinkers & Philosophers

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Contributions of moral thinkers and philosophers from India and world."

DECODED TOPICS:

Ideas of important moral thinkers and philosophers that can illuminate ethical reasoning.

MICROTOPICS:

- Major Indian moral thinkers
- Major global moral thinkers
- Core ethical ideas
- Application of philosophical ideas to public life

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Conceptual + Application

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Core ideas and their application.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid comprehensive academic history of philosophy.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Use contemporary governance or social dilemmas as application examples.

PURIFICATION NOTE:

Specific thinkers are **illustrative preparation choices**, not an official UPSC-prescribed list.

7. Public-Service Ethics, Ethical Dilemmas & Governance

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Public/Civil service values and Ethics in Public Administration: Status and problems; ethical concerns and dilemmas in government and private institutions; laws, rules, regulations and conscience as sources of ethical guidance; accountability and ethical governance; strengthening of ethical and moral values in governance; ethical issues in international relations and funding; corporate governance."

DECODED TOPICS:

Ethical decision-making within public institutions, government, private institutions and international relationships.

MICROTOPICS:

- Public-service values
- Ethical dilemmas
- Laws, rules, regulations and conscience
- Accountability
- Ethical governance
- Conflict of interest
- Ethical issues in international relations and funding
- Corporate governance

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Identify ethical conflicts, apply relevant principles and justify balanced decisions.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid technical corporate-audit manuals and unrelated legal procedure.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant governance, institutional and corporate ethical controversies.

PURIFICATION NOTE:

Constitutional morality, CSR and similar concepts can be useful analytical tools/examples, but should not be presented as separate official syllabus headings.

8. Probity in Governance

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Probity in Governance: Concept of public service; Philosophical basis of governance and probity; Information sharing and transparency in government, Right to Information, Codes of Ethics, Codes of Conduct, Citizen's Charters, Work culture, Quality of service delivery, Utilization of public funds, challenges of corruption."

DECODED TOPICS:

Integrity, transparency, accountability and ethical use of public authority and resources.

MICROTOPICS:

- Concept of public service
- Philosophical basis of probity
- Transparency and information sharing
- RTI
- Codes of Ethics
- Codes of Conduct
- Citizens' Charters
- Work culture
- Quality of service delivery
- Public-fund utilisation
- Corruption

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Understand the purpose, strengths, limitations and application of probity mechanisms.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid excessive organisational theory unrelated to governance and probity.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Relevant transparency, accountability and anti-corruption developments.

9. Case Studies

OFFICIAL SYLLABUS:

"Case Studies on above issues."

DECODED TOPICS:

Application of the above ethical concepts to practical decision-making situations.

MICROTOPICS:

- Identification of ethical issues
- Stakeholder identification
- Conflicting values
- Available options
- Consequences
- Legal and ethical considerations
- Public interest
- Feasible action

PYQ SIGNAL: Very High

EXAM FOCUS: Mains-Dominant

DEPTH: Detailed-High Priority

PREPARATION BOUNDARY:

- **Reasonable Depth:** Apply ethical reasoning, legality, public interest, empathy, accountability and administrative feasibility.
- **Where to Stop:** Avoid memorising rigid answer templates that replace genuine ethical reasoning.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS OVERLAY:

Real-world administrative situations may be used as examples, but case-study preparation remains grounded in the official GS-IV themes.

PURIFICATION NOTE:

Stakeholder mapping, option matrices and similar frameworks are **preparation tools**, not official UPSC case-study requirements.

Final CURSUS principle

